

Ali Ezzat, PhD

Senior / Principal Data Scientist — Forecasting, Optimization, Recommender Systems & Applied Deep Learning — Retail, Clean Energy & Sustainability

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Cairo, Egypt — Open to relocation (Europe, Japan)

SUMMARY

- Senior/Principal Data Scientist and PhD with **7+ years** leading end-to-end analytics engagements — time-series **forecasting, optimization, recommender systems**, causal inference and generative AI — across energy-intensive industrial manufacturing, supply chain, consumer/retail-facing services and finance.
- Delivered measurable operational and sustainability impact: **23% lower industrial energy (natural gas) consumption** with zero quality failures, **18% lower supply-network cost**, cash-forecasting error cut **15x** (300%→20%), and customer-targeting precision lifted **3%→25%**.
- Core toolkit — demand forecasting, network/inventory optimization, dynamic pricing, recommender systems, and churn/lead-scoring — maps directly onto **retail merchandising, demand planning, and clean-energy operations analytics**.
- Deep expertise in deep learning (PyTorch, Transformers), **LLM/GenAI system design, model benchmarking and fine-tuning**, and end-to-end production ML deployment (Docker, APIs, MLOps).
- Founded and scaled a **10-person data science team**; owned hiring, technical direction, and mentoring across client-facing production ML projects.
- Open to relocation to **Europe or Japan**.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Data Scientist Mar 2019 – Present

Synapse Analytics — Cairo, Egypt

- Founded and scaled the Data Science team from **1 to 10** data scientists; owned hiring end to end (screening, technical assessments, interviews).
- Led technical direction while remaining hands-on across production ML projects spanning retail analytics, energy-intensive manufacturing, supply chain, healthcare and finance.
- Designed production ML pipelines, Dockerized model APIs and deployment workflows with data engineering teams.
- Presented proof-of-concept demos to prospective clients; ran A/B tests to validate model improvements pre-deployment.
- Served as applied ML lead for **Konan**, the company's internal MLOps platform, translating production workflows into platform requirements — Konan now supports **~25 production models** across **~15 client deployments**.
- Mentored junior data scientists through model development and deployment.
- *Technologies: Python, R, SQL, Docker, Git, PyTorch, Transformers, XGBoost, scikit-learn, ggplot2, Plotly, Shiny*

Industrial Energy Optimization — Unilever (Clean Energy / Sustainability)

- Designed and deployed a real-time ML recommendation system on live sensor data (**20+ sensor and control tags**) from a detergent-manufacturing tower, recommending nozzle, burner and slurry-feed settings each cycle.
- Cut monthly **natural-gas consumption by 23%** using nearest-neighbor retrieval over historical operating logs to surface past machine states with favorable energy profiles under matching conditions.
- Built automated quality safeguards that handed control to rule-based corrective actions whenever moisture content or bulk density drifted out of specification, resulting in **zero production batch failures**.
- Separately built a multi-variant manufacturing scheduler generating time-minimizing schedules from a monthly demand sheet under line-speed, efficiency and specification constraints.

Supply Network & Logistics Optimization — Procter & Gamble (Retail / Sustainability)

- Built an optimization platform recommending warehouse/hub locations, routes, fleet and shipment frequencies to minimize total logistics cost.
- Reduced **total supply-network cost by 18%** versus the client's existing network, optimizing a **multi-echelon network** (hubs → branches → stores) with clustering for facility placement and a traveling-salesman algorithm for milk-run routes.
- Supported "brown-field" optimization, fixing selected existing facilities while optimizing the rest of the network; integrated HERE Maps routing and interactive Leaflet visualizations for operational stakeholders.

Demand Forecasting & Inventory Planning — Western Union, Grinta (Retail / Supply Planning)

- Western Union: built a branch-level time-series forecasting model for daily cash-withdrawal amounts, cutting cash over-supply error **from 300% to 20%**.
- Grinta: forecast medicine inventory replenishment, cutting carrying fees on unsold stock and missed sales from stock-outs.

Customer Analytics — Recommenders, Lead Scoring & Churn — Wayak Health, Dsquares, AMAN (Retail / CRM)

- Wayak Health: built an end-to-end lead-scoring pipeline (feature engineering, model training, weekly batch scoring) that lifted patient-conversion targeting precision **from 3% to 25%**.
- AMAN Financial Services: wrangled **100GB+** of point-of-sale transaction data across **100K+ merchants** and developed an XGBoost churn model reaching **79% precision**, with churn drivers surfaced to stakeholders via dashboards.
- Dsquares: built a **retail loyalty recommender** over redemption baskets from three loyalty programs — merchant-name entity resolution, association-rule mining, next-merchant recommendations ranked by confidence lift, and **RFM segmentation**.

Pricing & Marketplace Analytics — London Cab, Naqla, Sa3ar (Retail / Dynamic Pricing)

- London Cab: built temporal clustering models to identify optimal driver waiting locations by time of day, cutting passenger pickup times **by 13%**; designed a simulation dashboard for testing pricing strategies before deployment.
- Naqla: built an analytical dashboard plus deep-learning and XGBoost regression models to estimate truck-trip prices from shipment characteristics.
- Sa3ar: scraped a market dataset from classified listings and built a fair-price estimation model for used cars from specs, mileage and condition.

Credit Risk ML Platform — 12 Financial Institutions

- Architected and deployed credit-scoring pipelines for **12 financial institutions**, processing **100K+ loan applications/month** and facilitating **\$150M+ in lending**, cutting average default rates **40%**.
- Owned the complete ML lifecycle — data wrangling, EDA, feature engineering, model training, Dockerized APIs, and production support. Additional engagements: Tamweely, B.TECH, EGBank, Zeyada, Sarwa.

Generative AI & LLM Systems — Raya & Forsa

- Raya: built a multilingual (English/Arabic) GPT-4o pipeline extracting income, spending and vendor-category signals from SMS for thin-file alternative credit scoring; benchmarked frontier LLMs against a hand-labelled ground-truth set, then cut per-applicant inference cost by replacing them with **fine-tuned AraEuroBert models, one per extracted feature** — a message-type classifier ahead of per-feature extractors, with a QLoRA fine-tune of Llama 3.1 8B on GPT-4o-generated synthetic data as the parallel distillation route.
- Forsa: built GPT-4o-powered assistants for customer activation and for **WhatsApp collections** (via Twilio) — the collections agent negotiates payment dates and partial-payment plans, escalates tone by days overdue, hands off to humans past 30 days and is turn-limited; prompt-grounded RAG keeps responses policy-compliant in Egyptian Arabic, English and Franco-Arabic.
- Benchmarked the agent across **four LLM backends** (GPT-4o-mini, Claude 3.5 Sonnet, DeepSeek, o4-mini) against a hand-labeled ground-truth set, including a **self-hosted DeepSeek-R1 14B** run on-premise for data residency.

Scientific Advisor Aug 2018 – Mar 2019

Interstellar Consultation Services — Cairo, Egypt

- Supervised development of **dbparser**, an open-source R package for parsing and integrating public drug databases (DrugBank, KEGG) — **50K+ downloads** and active community adoption.
- Defined research directions and feature priorities aligned with drug-discovery workflows.

Research Scientist Jan 2013 – Jun 2013

Bilkent University — Ankara, Turkey

- Analysed **next-generation sequencing** data to identify asthma-associated genes, contrasting reads from healthy and affected individuals. Work carried out in collaboration with the Swiss Institute of Allergy and Asthma Research (SIAF).
- Also served as teaching assistant for an introductory Java programming course.

Software Engineer (Web Developer) Oct 2008 – May 2011

United OFOQ — Cairo, Egypt

- Delivered updates, fixes and on-site deployment (Amman, Jordan) for the Baggage Reconciliation System (BRS), and built the reporting functionality (JasperReports) for the OFOQ Talent Management System (OTMS).
- *Technologies: Java EE, JavaScript, IBM DB2, Oracle Database*

SKILLS

- **Forecasting & Optimization:** Time-series forecasting, demand planning, inventory optimization, network/facility-location optimization, vehicle routing (TSP), clustering, recommender systems, dynamic pricing
- **Machine Learning & Deep Learning:** End-to-end ML ownership, feature engineering, XGBoost, deep learning (PyTorch), causal inference, A/B testing, association analysis, RFM segmentation
- **Generative AI & NLP:** Large Language Models, multilingual NLP (English/Arabic), RAG, conversational AI (GPT-4o, Claude, LLaMA 3.1), prompt engineering, LLM benchmarking and evaluation, QLoRA fine-tuning (Unsloth), transformer fine-tuning (AraEuroBert)
- **Languages & Libraries:** Python, R, MATLAB, SQL · PyTorch, scikit-learn, pandas, NumPy, Transformers, HuggingFace, LangChain, Plotly, XGBoost, tidyverse, ggplot2, Shiny
- **Infrastructure & DevOps:** AWS, Docker, Git, MLflow, Spark, Jupyter, Neo4j

EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science *Aug 2013 – Jun 2018*

Nanyang Technological University — Singapore

- Research in ML-based prediction of drug-target interactions using ensemble learning, matrix factorization, manifold learning and class-imbalance-aware methods.
- Published **4 peer-reviewed papers** and **1 book chapter**; **Best Paper Award, InCoB 2016** (BMC Bioinformatics).
- **Thesis:** *Challenges and Solutions in Drug-Target Interaction Prediction*. Graduated with a CGPA of **4.88 / 5.00**.
- **Relevant graduate coursework:** Advanced Topic in Convex Optimisation, Data Mining, Computational Intelligence: Methods & Applications, High Performance Computing.

MSc in Bioinformatics *Aug 2011 – Dec 2012*

Nanyang Technological University — Singapore

- Graduated with a CGPA of **4.69 / 5.00**. Dissertation on structure-based prediction of ligand binding site residues.
- **Relevant coursework:** Biostatistics, Algorithms for Bioinformatics, High Performance Computing, Computational Biology.

BSc in Computer and Information Sciences *Sep 2002 – Aug 2006*

Ain Shams University — Cairo, Egypt

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- Computational Prediction of Drug–Target Interactions using Chemogenomic Approaches: An Empirical Survey — Briefings in Bioinformatics, 2018
- Drug–Target Interaction Prediction with Graph Regularized Matrix Factorization — IEEE/ACM TCBB, 2017
- Drug–Target Interaction Prediction using Ensemble Learning and Dimensionality Reduction — Methods (Elsevier), 2017
- Drug–Target Interaction Prediction via Class Imbalance-Aware Ensemble Learning — BMC Bioinformatics, 2016 (Best Paper Award, InCoB 2016)
- Computational Prediction of Drug–Target Interactions via Ensemble Learning — book chapter, In Silico Methods for Drug Repurposing, Springer, 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Forecasting & Optimization:** Time Series Analysis in Python · Manipulating Time Series Data in Python · Visualizing Time Series Data in Python · Introduction to Optimization in Python (DataCamp)
- **Deep Learning & NLP:** Deep Learning in Python skill track — PyTorch for images, text and Transformer models (DataCamp) · Machine Learning: Natural Language Processing (Udemy)
- **Generative AI:** Multimodal RAG — AI Search & Recommender Systems with GPT-4 · Neo4j: Cypher, GDS, GraphQL, LLM & Knowledge Graphs for RAG (Udemy)
- **Algorithms:** AlgoExpert — 100 data-structures and algorithms problems completed